Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 53, Number 3 | Sunnyvale, California | March 2010

Annual Election of Officers and Flood Insurance Questions!
Wednesday, March 10th at 7:00 pm Lakewood Park Building
Guests: Mike Klein from State Farm Insurance
and Richard Santos from Santa Clara Water District

President's Column

-Fred Fowler

Elections and Flood Insurance

Greetings! Please come to the Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, March 10th to take part in the next general meeting of the LVNA. The meeting will start at 7:00pm, and it should be an interesting one.

ELECTIONS

The first order of business will be the annual election of our officers. The LVNA bylaws stipulate that the organization will be governed by a committee of five people serving in different capacities. There is a President, who bears overall responsibility for the association. There is a "1st Vice President", who presides if the president cannot and also is responsible for overseeing publicity for the association. There is a "2nd Vice President" who presides if both the president and the 1st vice president cannot and chairs something called the "Grievance committee". There is a "Secretary" who keeps the records of the organization, and there is a "Treasurer" who handles the money and keeps the organization's books. Each officer serves a one-year term after being elected, and no one can serve as an elected officer for more than three consecutive terms.

This year we will have a bit of a challenge. The LVNA currently has a president (me), a 2nd vice president (Felipe Misch), and a treasurer (Bev Woidyla). We have had no 1st vice president for some time, and recently our secretary (Sarah Daugherty) resigned in order to take better care of some family issues she is facing. Felipe is finishing his third consecutive year on the LVNA board, and must rotate off in order to comply with the term limit rules we have in our Bylaws. That will leave us with just two returning officers – Bev and me.

(Continued on page 2)



FLOOD INSURANCE

The second topic we'll be discussing at the March meeting is the requirement for Federal Flood Insurance for Lakewood Village homeowners. As many of you know, Lakewood Village is right on the boundary between parts of Sunnyvale where homeowners are required to have flood insurance and parts where homeowners are not required to have it. At our last meeting, our neighbor Wendy Stanley reported that the maps of the "1% flood zone" had recently changed for Lakewood Village, and that she found out that her house is no longer in the danger zone. She had to contact her bank and persuade them, but they agreed to drop the requirement for her to have flood insurance. She says she has saved more than $1,000 as a result.

We will have 2 guests, Mike Klein from State Farm Insurance and Director Richard Santos from the Santa Clara Water District. Mike lives and works in Sunnyvale and will be explaining about Flood insurance and answer questions on flood insurance or home owners insurance. Director Santos can answer questions about the South Bay Salt Pond Restoration and the impact it has on the flooding map. He understands our concerns about flooding very well. As a resident of Alviso, he has been flooded 3 times!

My wife Phyllis has a digital copy of the flood map of Lakewood village and I will be bringing it to the March meeting. I will also bring a laptop computer, a wireless internet connection and a PC projector to show what the new boundaries of the flood zone are.

As I said, please come to the Lakewood Park building at 7:00pm on Wednesday, March 10th. We'll do some important business and then get some important information. I look forward to seeing you there!

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***Elections** cont.*

it turns out, the LVNA board cannot function with just two officers. The Bylaws (which serve as the LVNA's "constitution") require that board meetings must have a minimum of three officers present in order to conduct business. If we don't have three elected officers, we can't make any decisions legally. Without three officers, we won't be able legally to print this newsletter, organize Dumpster Day, apply for city grant funds, or engage in just about any other activity.

We need some new blood to serve on the LVNA board! On the 10th, we'll be electing new leaders to help take the LVNA through the 2010 association year. As of the date I am writing this article, there are a few people who are "thinking" about running for an office, but no one has made a definite commitment yet. I ask YOU to think about it, too! The main commitment you would have to make is to attend LVNA board meetings, which happen once per month. Other than that, the amount of time and energy you will have to contribute is completely up to you.

Over the years the LVNA has made a big difference for our neighborhood. From the graffiti wars of the 1990's to the picnics and parades we organize now, the LVNA has contributed a great deal toward making Lakewood Village a wonderful place to call home. The neighborhood needs the LVNA. And now, the LVNA needs you.

If you are interested in running for one of the LVNA open offices, please feel free to contact me prior to the March meeting. I'll be happy to answer any questions you have, and make sure your name is on the nominations list. I'll also thank you for stepping up to help your neighbors in this important way. Thanks in advance!

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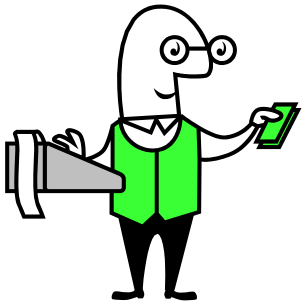
The *Villager* has a new editor!

By Fred Fowler

At the February board meeting of the LVNA, long-time *LVNA Villager* editor Christine Majchrowicz announced that it was time for her to move on. After several years of dealing with printing deadlines and other headaches, she has decided to turn the job of producing the neighborhood newsletter over to a new, fresh pair of hands. Many thanks to her for her long and dedicated service to Lakewood Village!

The new editor is none other than Phyllis Fowler, Sunnyvale school board trustee, former Girl Scout leader, and my better half. Phyllis is excited about the challenge of producing a publication each month that goes to more than 1,700 recipients. She hopes to follow in the footsteps of Christy and the other past editors of *The Villager*, and produce a newsletter that maintains the same high standards of quality and relevance that have characterized it over the years.

AARP Free Tax Service



The AARP is doing taxes (non-complicated ones) for anyone for **free!!!**

From now until April 9, **Sunnyvale Community Services** at 725 Kifer Road, near Home Depot

For information, or to set up an appointment, call the AARP coordinator at (408) 735-0653. Taxes will be done on Thursdays & Fridays from 9am - 2pm.

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Try out the new LVNA.NET Website!

By Fred Fowler

When was the last time you browsed the LVNA website? (Really? That long ago?).

A few years back our neighbor Brian Smithson created a beautiful website for us that was full of good information, neighborhood history, and even pictures. Brian did it when he had some spare time and energy to devote to the project. He did a fine job! Unfortunately, Brian's spare time ran out soon afterward, and the website languished a bit, suffering from "benign neglect". Time flies, and before we knew it the website's "current events" were more than two years old.

I'm happy to report that this situation is changing! I would like to announce the re-birth of the LVNA website! I would like to introduce the "LVNA Villager Online", the new internet based newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association! You can reach it at http://www.lvna.net.

If you point your browser at this URL you will notice a distinct change from the old website. Brian's creation was meant as a kind of "reference book" about Lakewood Village, with little bits of history mixed in with contact numbers and the names of LVNA officials. The new website is meant to be a kind of "newspaper", where you can go to get information about current events and issues affecting the neighborhood. It is a different approach, and I hope it will be appealing enough for you and the rest of Lakewood Village to visit it often.

Another feature of the new website is that it is meant to be an "interactive" resource rather than just a place to read things. There is a "classified advertisement" section where anyone can post a "classified advertisement" free of charge. Another section that is under development is an "ask City Hall" function that lets you add questions to a kind of blog and then see the answers that come back.

There is a "Neighborhood News" section of the web site that will have the latest information about what's happening in and around Lakewood Village. There will also be a "Lakewood Village Showcase" section where there will be profiles of the different churches, volunteer organizations and businesses that are a part of our neighborhood. Finally, there will be a complete record of the meetings, officers, reports and bylaws of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association.

I am personally excited about the idea of an "electronic newsletter" because of the restrictions it lifts compared to our printed one. Back in the 1990s I spent two years writing news for the neighborhood, and I always had to fight battles with the fact that there is only so much room for what has to be said when you are limited to just six printed pages. I also regretted that we could not afford to print the newsletter in color, preventing us from showing pictures of the beauty of our neighborhood.

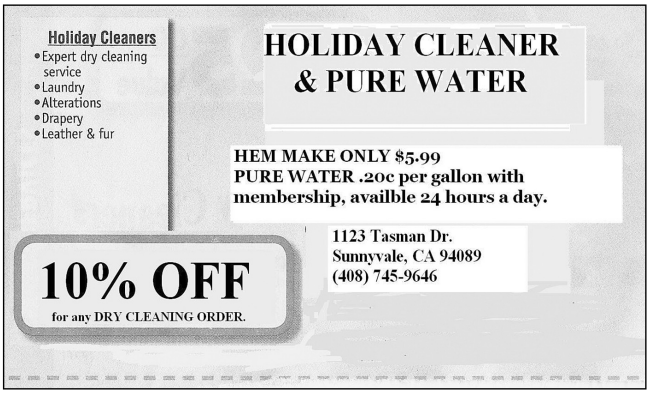
With the online newsletter, those problems are solved! There is enough space for everything because there is no limit to how many pages we may publish. Even better, we can now mix pictures (and even sound) together with text to do a better job of telling the story. If you want to see what I mean, please check out the article about our latest LVNA parade on the web site. I think you'll agree that the pictures make a world of difference! And we're just getting started!

Please take the time to log on to http://www.lvna.net and have a look. Please keep checking it – current events will be updated there every week. It is still under construction, (so please pardon our dust), but please feel free to give direct feedback about it. Please send your comments to my e-mail address: fred@fmfa.com. Thanks!

The only way to keep your health is to eat what you don't want, drink what you don't like, and do what you'd rather not..

- Mark Twain





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Fairwood School Rummage Sale!

May 15th
From 8am to 2pm

One persons junk can be someone else's treasure. Who knows what treasures you might uncover! You just might find the very item you have been searching for years! Support our Fairwood kids and have fun doing it!

Come one, come all to spectacular rummage sale at Fairwood School

"To the praise of the glory of His grace . . ."

Providence Bible Church of Sunnyvale
709 Lakewood Drive, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
408-734-2297 **http://www.lvbc-ca.org**

Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

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Lakewood Pony Baseball 2010 Season is Here!

Registration: There is still time to register, call 408-230-9388 or email lakewoodponybaseball@yahoo.com

Divisions and Cost:
***Jr. Shetland** (6 & under) **: $70.00**
Shetland (5-6 year olds) **: $100.00**
Pinto (7-8 year olds)**: $125.00**
Mustang (9-10 year olds)**: $125.00**
Bronco (11-12 year olds)**: $125.00**

*New this year Jr. Shetland will only play on Saturdays.

Volunteer Fee: $25.00 per child (Returned after Snack Shack Duty is complete)

Opening Day: Saturday March 20, 2010
Closing ceremonies: Saturday June 5, 2010

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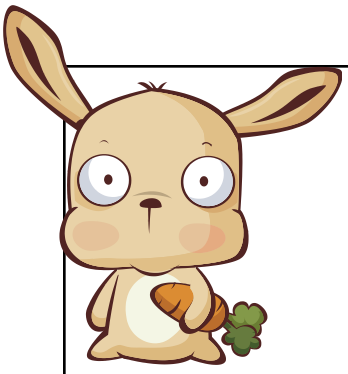
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Bunny 101
This is a *FREE* event!
Benefitting
The Rabbit Haven

Sunday March 28
@ For Other Living Things
1261 S. Mary Ave

Thinking of getting a pet rabbit this Easter Season. Already got a bunny and questions? Learn all you all you need to know from the experts at The Rabbit Haven, a non-profit rabbit rescue group. Handmade chocolate bunnies from Schurras with proceeds benefiting The Rabbit Haven.

Need something new to read?

I always do! Then come down to the Sunnyvale Public Library and pick up some bargains. The Friends of the Library are having a book sale!

March 27th and 28th
Saturday from 10am to 5pm
Sunday from noon to 4pm

Special Events:

Coco's Bakery Restaurant
Presents — Tip-A-Cop
Tuesday, April 13
Breakfast: 7:00am—10:30am
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Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety - Emergency	**911**
Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Complaints, about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses, or rental housing	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	3/2 Fairwood 3/9 Lakewood 4/6 Fairwood 4/13 Lakewood
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center Orchard Heritage Building	3/13 10 am.-12pm
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	Carl Road, near SMaRT Station	3/20 8 am - 1 pm
LVNA *Villager* Editorial Deadline	Contact editor@lvna.net	3/26

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• Sewer Drain Cleaning
• Clean-out Installation
• Video Camera Inspection
• Pipe Locator
• Bathroom Remodeling
• Tilework
• Gasline

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